10th Class English • Unit 3 • Punjab Board (New Syllabus 2026)

Digital Globalisation Transforming the English Language

Fully solved exercises: comprehension, MCQs, glossary, adjectival/prepositional/adverbial phrases, denotation and connotation, partner interview, paragraph writing with hook and lead-in

A. The Essay at a Glance

Type: a non-fiction, expository essay. **Style:** formal, objective and informative. **Organisation:** mainly **list/sequence of ideas** (vocabulary → grammar → pronunciation → culture) mixed with **cause-effect** (digital technology causes change in language) and **problem-solution** (English dominates, so local languages must be preserved by conscious effort).

Central idea: digital globalisation has changed English in four ways — it has **expanded vocabulary**, **relaxed grammar**, **blended accents and other languages into it**, and made it a truly global language. The change is not only a loss; it is also growth, creativity and diversity.

Paragraph	Main point
1–2 (intro)	Digital globalisation = fast spread of digital technology and global connectivity; it has changed economies, cultures and most of all English, which is now the dominant digital language.
3	New vocabulary: neologisms such as hashtag, selfie, unfriend, meme, and abbreviations such as LOL, BTW, DM.
4	Blending: English as a lingua franca absorbs words (hijab, sushi, aesthetic) and code-switching produces hybrid dialects such as Taglish and Singlish.
5	Grammar: texting and tweeting omit articles, punctuation and capitals; some call it a decline, others a creative adaptation. Emojis work like modern hieroglyphs.
6	Speech: YouTube and global media blend accents and spread American and British slang, but regional accents may be lost.
7	Concern: English dominance puts pressure on non-native speakers and can push smaller languages towards extinction.
8–10	Counter-view and conclusion: English has become more inclusive and diverse (Ghanaian, Filipino, Pakistani examples); the overall effect is growth, change and adaptation.

B. Questions Given Beside the Text

1. What do you think the phrase “digital globalisation” means?

Digital globalisation means the fast spread of digital technology — the internet, social media, smartphones and online platforms — across the whole world, so that people of different countries share information, culture and language within seconds. In this unit the phrase means that as the world becomes digitally connected, the English language spreads with it and changes with it.

2. How might global use of the internet influence the way English is spoken or written?

The internet influences English in four clear ways. It **adds new words** (hashtag, selfie, meme); it **relaxes writing** because messages are short and fast, so capitals and punctuation are dropped; it **blends accents** because YouTube and films spread American and British speech all over the world; and it **mixes English with local languages**, producing new varieties such as Singlish and Taglish.

3. What is code-switching, and how does it reflect the influence of digital globalisation on English?

Code-switching is the practice of mixing two or more languages in the same conversation or sentence, for example an Urdu sentence with English words inside it. It reflects digital globalisation because online conversations are read by people of many languages at the same time, so the speaker uses the English word where it is shorter or clearer and his own word where it carries feeling. The result is hybrid varieties such as Taglish and Singlish, which prove that English now belongs to its users and not only to native speakers.

4. How does the dominance of English on digital platforms create both opportunities and challenges for speakers of local languages?

Opportunities: English opens the door to education, jobs, business, entertainment and information, because most platforms and websites are in English. A student from a small town can learn from the same material as a student in London. **Challenges:** the same pressure makes local languages look less useful, so they lose speakers, literature and prestige, and a language can die within two generations. The challenge, therefore, is to gain English without losing our own language.

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C. Reading Comprehension — Answer the following questions

1. What is digital globalisation, and how is it connected to the English language?

Digital globalisation is the rapid expansion of digital technologies and global connectivity in the 21st century. It has changed economies and cultures, and it has changed languages — most of all English. The connection is simple: the internet, social media, YouTube and online business mostly use English, so English travels with every click to every country, and every country shapes English in return. That is why the essay says English both **spreads** through digital platforms and **evolves** because of them.

2. Give examples of vocabulary that emerged through digital globalisation.

New words (neologisms): hashtag, selfie, unfriend, meme, blog, emoji. **Abbreviations:** LOL (laugh out loud), BTW (by the way), DM (direct message). **Borrowed words now used freely in English:** hijab (Arabic), sushi (Japanese), aesthetic (Greek). All these words were either invented or popularised by digital platforms, and they were born out of the need for speed and efficiency.

3. What is code-switching, and how does it appear in online communication?

Code-switching is mixing two or more languages in the same message, sentence or conversation. In online communication it appears in chat, comments, captions and vlogs, where a Pakistani writes an Urdu sentence with English words like “actually”, “seriously” or “update” in the middle, or a Filipino mixes Tagalog with English (Taglish) and a Singaporean mixes Chinese, Malay and English (Singlish). It shows the flexibility that digital globalisation has encouraged.

4. How has digital communication affected traditional grammar rules?

Traditional grammar still rules in formal writing, but in texting, tweeting and chatting a relaxed approach has appeared. Because space and time are limited, users omit articles, punctuation and even capital letters — “I am going to the store” becomes “goin 2 store”. Sentences become shorter, emojis replace words, and spelling is often phonetic. Some people say this is a decline in language standards; others say it is a creative adaptation to new tools. Both views are present in the essay.

5. What concerns does the author raise about the dominance of English on digital platforms?

The author raises two main concerns. **First, cultural dominance:** because English is the default language of most platforms, non-native speakers feel forced to adopt it to get information, take part in conversations or find jobs. **Second, inequality and language death:** this dominance marginalises local languages and speeds up their decline, and smaller languages “risk extinction if they are not preserved through conscious effort”. The author also notes the possible loss of regional accents and of linguistic purity.

6. Do you agree with the author's claim that English is becoming more flexible and creative due to digital globalisation?

Yes, I agree with the claim, and the essay proves it with evidence. Flexibility is visible in code-switching and in hybrid varieties such as Taglish and Singlish, where English freely borrows grammar and words from other languages. Creativity is visible in neologisms (selfie, unfriend), in abbreviations (LOL, DM) and in emojis that carry complex feelings in a single sign. One may add that this creativity sometimes damages accuracy — “goin 2 store” is not good English — but damage to a standard is not the same as damage to the language. The language itself has grown richer.

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7. How do emojis and memes function as a new kind of language?

Emojis and memes work like a language because they carry meaning that everyone in a community understands without words. A single heart or fire emoji shows love or praise, a laughing emoji changes the tone of a sentence, and a crying one shows grief; in the same way a meme — a picture with a short caption — makes a joke or a comment about politics, school or daily life. They act like modern-day hieroglyphs: a small picture stands for a word or an idea. Their weakness is that they are not precise and vary from culture to culture, which is why they support words rather than fully replace them.

D. Choose the Correct Option (MCQs) — solved with key

1. What is the meaning of code-switching as used in the essay?

- changing passwords frequently
- mixing English with another language in conversation
- switching between slang and emojis
- using only formal English in digital spaces

Answer: mixing English with another language in conversation — The essay gives Taglish and Singlish as examples of this mixing.

2. Which of the following is an example of a word created or popularised by digital platforms?

- friend
- hashtag
- television
- grammar

Answer: hashtag — Hashtag, selfie, unfriend and meme are named as neologisms of social media.

3. Why do people often break grammar rules in online messages?

- They don't know the rules.
- It is faster and more efficient in digital communication.
- Online platforms encourage spelling errors.
- Teachers tell them not to use grammar online.

Answer: It is faster and more efficient in digital communication. — The essay links short forms with the need for speed and limited characters.

4. What role do emojis play in modern English?

- They distract from real meanings.
- They are used only by teenagers.
- They serve as a replacement or support for words.
- They improve vocabulary.

Answer: They serve as a replacement or support for words. — Emojis add a visual element and can even replace words, like hieroglyphs.

5. What is a possible negative impact of English dominating digital spaces?

- Everyone will become fluent in English.
- Local languages may decline or disappear.
- People will stop reading books.
- People will stop using emojis.

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Answer: Local languages may decline or disappear. — The essay warns that smaller languages risk extinction.

6. What does the essay suggest about English spoken around the world today?

- It is exactly the same everywhere.
- It is becoming less important.
- It is shaped by global media and cultural blending.
- It is mostly used by older generations.

Answer: It is shaped by global media and cultural blending. — Accents blend through YouTube and media, and local varieties are emerging.

7. Which of the following best defines lingua franca as used in the unit?

- a local dialect spoken in France
- a common language used by speakers of different native languages
- a universal sign language
- a type of digital slang

Answer: a common language used by speakers of different native languages — The essay calls English a bridge language between different native tongues.

E. Glossary — Words and Meanings

Word	Meaning
abbreviations	a shortened form of a word or phrase
controversial	causing disagreement
conversation	a talk, especially an informal one
evolve	develop gradually
exposure	the state of being given access to something, so that it can be seen or experienced
fascinating	extremely interesting
flexibility	the ability to be easily modified
hieroglyphs	a stylised picture of an object representing a word, syllable or sound
hybrid	a thing made by combining two different elements
inclusive	including all the people, services or items
omit	leave out or exclude
profound	(of a state, quality or emotion) very great or intense
traditional	produced, done or used in accordance with tradition
witnessed	has knowledge of a development from observation or experience

Note the spelling pair: “evolve” (verb) — “evolution” (noun); “exposure” comes from “expose”.

F. Vocabulary and Grammar

1. Adjectival, prepositional and adverbial phrases

Type of phrase	What it does	Example
Adjectival phrase	Describes a noun or pronoun; tells what kind or which one	The book **on the top shelf** is mine.
Prepositional phrase	Begins with a preposition and ends with a noun or pronoun; can work as an adjective or as an adverb	She sat **under the tree**.
Adverbial phrase	Modifies a verb, an adjective or another adverb; tells how, when, where or why	He ran **with great speed**.

2. Identify the type of phrase (solved)

Sentence	Phrase	Type and function
The girl with the red scarf is my cousin.	with the red scarf	Prepositional phrase used as an **adjectival** phrase — it describes "girl".
We walked along the beach at sunset.	along the beach / at sunset	Prepositional phrases used as **adverbial** phrases — one tells where, the other tells when.
He responded in a rude manner.	in a rude manner	Prepositional phrase used as an **adverbial** phrase — it tells how he responded.
The house by the river is abandoned.	by the river	Prepositional phrase used as an **adjectival** phrase — it describes "house".
They arrived after the ceremony.	after the ceremony	Prepositional phrase used as an **adverbial** phrase — it tells when they arrived.

3. Phrases in the paragraph about the dog and the boy

Type	Phrases from the passage
Adjectival phrases	"with the golden fur" (describes the dog), "in a blue jacket" (describes the boy), "of coffee" (describes the scent)
Prepositional phrases	"with the golden fur", "under the old wooden table", "during the quiet afternoon", "in a blue jacket", "with great interest", "on the windowpane", "of coffee"

Type	Phrases from the passage
Adverbial phrases	“under the old wooden table” (tells where it slept), “during the quiet afternoon” (tells when), “with great interest” (tells how he watched)

Remember: a prepositional phrase is named by its form, and an adjectival or adverbial phrase by its work. The same prepositional phrase can do both jobs, so always say what it describes.

4. Denotative and connotative meanings

Word	Denotative meaning	Connotative meaning
snake	a legless reptile	danger, betrayal
home	a place where one lives	warmth, family, comfort
cheap	low in price	inferior quality (negative)
inexpensive	low in price	good value (positive)

Same denotation, different connotation: “slim” and “skinny” both mean thin in body, but “slim” suggests attractiveness (positive) while “skinny” suggests being underweight or unhealthy (negative). **Related but different:** a house is a building; a home is a place where a person lives with love, so “home” carries warmth.

5. The passage about the old man — denotation, connotation, synonyms

Word	Denotative (literal) meaning	Connotation in the passage
frugal	careful in spending money; economical	**Positive** — wise and sensible, used by “some”
stingy	unwilling to give or spend money	**Negative** — mean and selfish, used in the whisper
simple	not complicated; plain in style	**Negative here** — dull and lifeless, not comfortable
cold	having a low temperature	**Negative** — unfriendly, unwelcoming
bare	not covered; empty	**Negative** — lonely and lacking warmth or care

The same man is “frugal” in one mouth and “stingy” in another: the denotation is close, but the connotation decides whether we feel respect or dislike.

Word	Synonyms offered	My choice and reason
frugal	economical / cheap	**economical** — positive and respectful, so it fits a neutral description of the old man.
stingy	thrifty / greedy	**thrifty** — if the writer wants a neutral word; **greedy** if the writer wants to criticise him.

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Word	Synonyms offered	My choice and reason
cold	unwelcoming / minimalist	**unwelcoming** — it carries the negative feeling of the passage; “minimalist” is a design word.
bare	plain / empty	**empty** — it suggests loneliness, which is the mood of the passage.

G. Oral Communication Skills — Partner Interview

A good interview has four rules: **take turns**, **listen attentively** (eye contact, a nod, no interrupting), **speak with standard pronunciation and intonation** at a natural pace, and **report back** in the third person — you introduce your partner, not yourself.

Model report back to the class

Respected teacher and dear class-fellows, I interviewed my partner Ali Raza, and I would like to introduce him. Ali is passionate about photography, because he says a photograph can save a moment that will never come again; he began with his mobile phone and now uses a camera so that he can control the settings himself. His favourite memory of the past year is the day his school reopened after the summer, when he photographed the morning assembly. If he could travel anywhere, he would go to Murree, to capture the pine trees and the fog. The new skill he wants to learn is swimming, because he is afraid of deep water and wants to defeat that fear. Thank you, Ali, for sharing, and thank you, class-fellows, for listening.

What to observe in the book's sample interview: the two students greet each other, ask one question at a time, add a short comment (“That sounds really cool”) before the next question, give reasons with their answers, and finish by summing up the partner in one line. Copy this pattern and your interview will sound natural.

H. Writing Skills — A Clear and Well-Developed Paragraph

A well-developed paragraph has **five parts**: a **hook** that grabs attention, a **lead-in** that connects the hook with the topic, a **topic sentence** that states the main idea, **supporting sentences** that explain and give examples, and a **closing sentence** that rounds off the idea.

Model paragraph 1: “Digital technology has changed the way we communicate”

[Hook] Imagine a home where four people sit in one room and none of them speaks, because all four are typing.

[Lead-in] This is no longer imagination; it is what happens in thousands of Pakistani homes every evening.

[Topic sentence] Digital technology has significantly changed the way we communicate, and the change is not entirely for the better.

[Supporting sentences] People now depend on instant messaging and social media instead of face-to-face conversation, so a message reaches another city in a second and a message to the next room is also sent by phone. This speed is a

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blessing in emergencies and in study groups, because a student can send a question at midnight and get an answer at once. But speed also reduces depth: a short “ok” replaces a smile, an emoji replaces a word of comfort, and a long quarrel is settled with a single full stop. The result is communication that is faster, wider and flatter.

[Closing sentence] Digital tools should therefore be used as a bridge to people, not as a wall in front of them.

Model paragraph 2: “English is changing, not dying”

[Hook] A language that refuses to change is a language that is already dead.

[Lead-in] English has always borrowed, shortened and mixed itself with other tongues, and the internet has only made that habit faster.

[Topic sentence] Digital globalisation is changing English, but it is changing it by growth and not by decay.

[Supporting sentences] New words such as selfie, hashtag and meme have entered the dictionary within a few years, which shows the creativity of ordinary users. Code-switching has produced varieties like Singlish and Taglish, and a Pakistani vlogger's Urdu-English mix is understood by millions. Grammar has relaxed in chat and tweets, but formal writing still follows the old rules, so the standard has not collapsed; it has simply been given a second, informal register. What we must protect is not the purity of English but the health of our own languages.

[Closing sentence] So let us enjoy the flexibility of English while keeping Urdu and our regional languages alive at home.

I. Objective Summary of the Essay

In the 21st century, digital technology and global connectivity have spread English across the world and have changed it in four main ways. First, vocabulary has expanded with neologisms such as hashtag, selfie, unfriend and meme, and with abbreviations such as LOL, BTW and DM. Second, English, used as a lingua franca, absorbs words from other cultures and produces hybrid varieties through code-switching, for example Taglish and Singlish. Third, grammar has been relaxed in texting and tweeting, where articles, punctuation and capitals are often omitted, and emojis now add a visual layer to meaning like modern hieroglyphs. Fourth, pronunciation and accent are being shaped by global media, which blends accents but may erase regional ones. The essay also raises the concern that the dominance of English pressures non-native speakers and pushes smaller languages towards extinction. It concludes, however, that the overall effect is not negative: English has become more inclusive and diverse, reflecting the voices of users all over the world, and it will keep adapting to the needs of its global speakers.

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Points to Remember

• Digital globalisation = rapid spread of digital technology and global connectivity; it spread English and changed it.

• Four areas of change: vocabulary, grammar, pronunciation/accents, cultural identity.

• New words: hashtag, selfie, unfriend, meme. Abbreviations: LOL, BTW, DM. Borrowed: hijab, sushi, aesthetic.

• Code-switching = mixing two languages in one message; results in Taglish and Singlish.

• Lingua franca = a bridge language used between speakers of different native languages.

• Emojis and memes work like modern hieroglyphs — pictures that carry meaning.

• Concerns: cultural dominance, pressure on non-native speakers, decline and possible extinction of local languages, loss of regional accents.

• Three phrase types: adjectival (describes a noun), prepositional (starts with a preposition), adverbial (tells how, when, where, why).

• Denotation = dictionary meaning; connotation = emotional association. slim/skinny, cheap/inexpensive, frugal/stingy.

• Paragraph structure: hook → lead-in → topic sentence → supporting sentences → closing sentence.

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